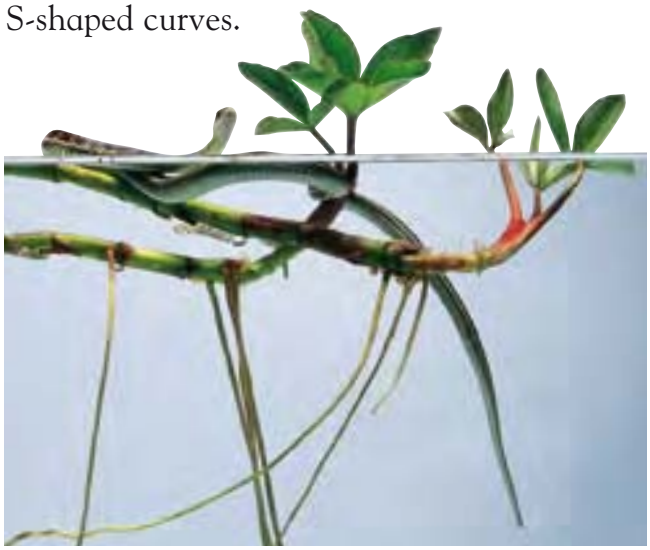
Swampland swimmers

The flexible body of a snake, such as this garter snake, helps to make it a good swimmer. It can glide through the water by moving its body from side to side in S-shaped curves.



Stretch and snap

A snapping turtle does not have to move fast to catch its food – its stretchy neck and violent bite will do all the work. This miniature monster will eat anything it can fit between its jaws!

A safer place

Green iguanas find that the tree branches around mangrove swamps are great places for sunbathing. Their leafy-green coloring hides them from predators – so they can relax.

Green iguanas use their tails for swimming, and as a defensive whip.

A FISHING LESSON

The largest freshwater turtle in the Americas is the alligator snapping turtle (see page 33), which "fishes" for its food. It lies in wait with its sharp, beaklike jaws wide open. There is a pink bulge on its tongue that looks like a fisherman's worm – this is the bait that attracts fish, which then have no escape as the jaws quickly snap shut.

